

Another good feature for HR managers is to monitor who is viewing their employees' profiles. This helps them in making better strategies to retain and engage their employees, suggests Singhal.

Use the platform to know your customers and market better

You must have hired research agencies or set up a department to research market trends, demography of people who are likely to buy your products, the strengths and weaknesses of competing products, and so on. You can do this research effectively using your company's LinkedIn account.

Volkswagen India did the same when it launched its cars in the Indian market. Apart from the sensational 'talking newspaper' campaign to promote its Vento car, the company launched a marketing campaign on LinkedIn, to assess the demographic details of the likely buyers.

Facebook versus LinkedIn

Of late, both LinkedIn and Facebook have emerged as interesting marketing tools. Considering the popularity of these platforms, marketers are using these media as a tool to expand the reach of their business, build brand image and influence buying decisions in their favour. Each has its unique value proposition to offer. However, the suitability of these media varies from business to business.

Facebook is a popular social media platform for people to connect with friends and family, while LinkedIn has emerged as a networking domain for working professionals.

Nishant Jain, Phonetics Mobile Media, feels that while Facebook is a good medium for B2C businesses, B2B businesses can find LinkedIn to be a better place as it can be used more to find vendors, reach out to potential investors, make refined search to reach the correct target audience and so on.

"None of the above-mentioned activities could be effectively done via Facebook. In fact, some of your friends might even ban you if you start using their network for business purpose," Jain adds.

So while LinkedIn has a more professional appeal than Facebook, the latter is more for attracting and engaging a consumer.

"Precise geographical and profession-based customer targeting helped in planning dealership locations, customising the marketing pitch, and building other strategies around the insights gathered from this medium," reveals Deepa Sapatnekar, senior PR manager, LinkedIn India.

The Volkswagen campaign gener-

ated 2700 car recommendations in four weeks. Indeed, when people begin to endorse products, it has a viral effect.

Jain shares, "One of our existing clients approached us via LinkedIn and shared his requirements with us. We were able to close the deal much faster as the client was recommended our name by somebody in the network."

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